

investment, particularly for 101.6cm (40-inch) size or bigger.

Which technology do you like?

This is the first and foremost question to ask yourself before selecting a 3D television. While the passive polarised 3D displays look pretty impressive, these can burn a hole in your pocket. So, if you are looking for a good 3D experience at a reasonable price, active shutter glasses based TV may suit you better.

Plasma or LCD/LED. Before you actually buy one, you must understand what a 3D television is all about. In simple terms, a 3D television can project images and videos in a three-dimensional way. How the technology works is that, the eye sees the images from different angles, than in real life, and the brain puts that information together and interprets the third dimension.

There is a wide range of 3D televisions available in the market that are coupled with display technologies including plasma and LCD/LED. The two technologies are different from each other in the way they process and display content, offering different experiences. One of the main differences is that of processing speed. While LCD technology has evolved over a period of time to offer better processing speeds (120Hz, 240Hz and 480Hz), plasma technology never faced the issue of processing speeds.

Given their processing speeds, LCD televisions are generally incapable of showing 3D content in full HDTV 1080p. These are able to deliver 600 lines of effective resolution capability in case of 120Hz HDTV and 700-800 lines of effective resolution in case of 240Hz television. However, plasma technology is capable of delivering full 1080 lines of resolution, desired in case of 3D television. This is not a major issue because 600-700 lines of effective resolution is also pretty good for most purposes.

Another advantage that plasma technology brings is in-depth perception. Plasma cells have a pixel structure that yields slightly better depth in a picture. However, LCD/LED televisions

Comparison of Optional Viewing Distances

3D television size (cm)	Optimal viewing distance 720p (cm)	Optimal viewing distance 1080p (cm)
106.7	246.4	167.6
127	292.1	198.1
139.7	322.6	218.4
152.4	350.5	238.8
165.1	381	256.5

win when it comes to brightness and colour-vibrancy. Overall, plasma technology is good for handling 3D content; however, the quality may vary from brand to brand.

Price. While you may want the best technology and experience, it is important you set a budget and check out the best options available in that range. In India, the price of a 101.6cm (40-inch) or slightly bigger 3D television starts at ₹ 40,000 and goes up to ₹ 160,000.

Screen resolution and viewing distance. When you go to a shop to buy a 3D television, the sales person will often emphasise on screen resolution. While 1080p resolution sounds and views better than 720p resolution, the resolution should always be determined on the basis of display size and the distance at which the television is to be kept from the viewers.

Refresh rates. If you are investing in a plasma 3D television, refresh rates are really not an issue because this technology has naturally high refresh rates and are well-suited for 3D technology.

However, if you are buying an LCD/LED variant, look for a high refresh rate to avoid any perceivable flicker. The minimum refresh rate for an LCD 3D television is 120Hz.

Online or brick-and-mortar stores. This is a choice that you have to make for yourself. Usually, there are deals offered by online stores. But, before you choose the online option, do visit a large retail showroom to take a look at the actual product. Also, read the terms and conditions of online stores to avoid any service-related issues at a later stage. ●

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Operating Modes	ON Delay, Interval, Start Delta, Cycle ON, First OFF First, Forward-Pause-Reverse, True power OFF
Time Ranges	30 Sec. to 30 Sec. 3/10/30/60 Sec/Min, 1/30/10/30 Sec/Min/Hz, 1/2/4/8 Sec/Min/Hz, 1/10 Sec/Min/Hz
Output Contact	# PNO1 (1 C/O) # PNO2 (2 C/O)
Contact Rating	5A @ 230VAC 24VDC
Supply Voltage	110VAC, 230VAC, 415VAC, 24VAC/DC, 20-240VAC, 12-240VDC



Size	72*72mm 95*95mm 144*144mm
Tone	2 Tones, 4 Tones, 110dB Output
Flasher	With Flasher / Without Flasher
Accept Functions	Push Button On Front and/or Terminals on Back
Volume Control	Yes, 10 to 100%
Supply Voltage	230VAC 24VDC, 20-240VAC, 12-240VDC

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